LA-Z-BOY · MANUFACTURING DEVELOPMENT

Coach's Playbook

Hypothetical Table of Contents and Coach Challenges

Prepared for discussion · November 11, 2026

ABOUT THIS DRAFT

Built from the November 3, 2026 conversation with Tim McCurry (a 200-page coach's playbook, Training Within Industry (TWI), 144 cells, 75% made to order) and the standard TWI modules. This is not La-Z-Boy's document. Section titles and challenges are placeholders to discuss and correct. Challenges marked From the call trace to what Tim McCurry said; the rest are assumptions to check.

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01 The cell coach role

- What a cell coach owns: safety, quality, flow, people
- A coach's shift, start to finish
- Working with the plant manager, industrial engineering and EHS

02 Reading the day's build mix

- What made-to-order means for the cell: fabric, motion or power, options
- Spotting difficult builds before they reach the cell
- Staffing the cell for the day's mix

03 Start-of-shift routine

- Safety huddle
- Yesterday's output and quality
- Confirming frames, fabric and mechanisms are staged

04 Keeping flow: the levers

- Signs that flow is breaking down
- Lever: rebalance work across stations
- Lever: move a cross-trained technician
- Lever: resequence orders
- Lever: escalate materials or maintenance
- Which lever for which situation (decision table)

05 Job Instruction (TWI): teaching a new technician

- Breaking down a job into steps, key points and reasons
- The four-step instruction method
- Keeping the cross-training matrix current

06 Job Relations (TWI): handling people problems

- The four-step method for a people problem
- Giving feedback on a missed standard
- Recognizing good work

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07 Job Methods (TWI): improving a station

- Break down, question, develop, apply
- Getting a technician's improvement idea adopted

08 Safety in the cell

- Running a short safety talk
- Recognizing safe behavior
- Correcting an unsafe act
- Ergonomics at sewing and upholstery stations
- Injury response and reporting

09 Quality in the cell

- Checkpoints by build stage
- Responding to a defect found downstream
- Recording and reducing scrap and rework

10 End of shift and handoff

- Results, open issues and handoff notes

11 Coach measures

- Output against plan, first-pass quality, scrap, recordable injuries, cross-training coverage

A Appendices

- Standard work forms, escalation contacts, glossary

Coach Challenges

SAFETY

1. **Correcting unsafe acts by scolding** FROM THE CALL
   Coaches correct unsafe behavior after the fact instead of coaching it, so technicians hide near misses.
2. **Safety talks read as compliance**
   Start-of-shift safety talks are read aloud and not tied to that day's builds or stations.
3. **Ergonomic risk goes uncorrected**
   Coaches don't spot or correct lifting, reaching and repetitive motion at sewing, stapling and frame stations, which drives workers' compensation cost.
4. **Shortcuts tolerated under flow pressure** FROM THE CALL
   When the build mix disrupts flow, coaches let technicians skip steps with knives, staple guns or guarding to catch up.
5. **Thin instruction for new and moved technicians**
   Technicians new to a station, or moved there to cover a gap, start without full instruction on its hazards.
6. **Low near-miss reporting**
   Coaches don't ask for near misses or act on them, so the same hazards repeat.

QUALITY

1. **Too much variety to check by memory** FROM THE CALL
   With 75% made to order and 800 fabrics, builds go out with the wrong fabric, wrong hand, or motion instead of power.
2. **Defects caught downstream don't come back**
   A defect found at final inspection or by the customer doesn't get back to the station and technician who caused it.
3. **No clear call on stopping the cell** FROM THE CALL
   Coaches aren't sure when a quality problem justifies stopping the cell and when to keep flow and fix it later.
4. **Drift from the standard method**
   Technicians move away from the Job Instruction method over time, and coaches don't check whether it is followed.
5. **Scrap and rework go unrecorded**
   Fabric miscuts and rework aren't recorded consistently, so no one sees the pattern or the cost.

6 **Avoiding the hard conversation**

Coaches avoid talking to a technician about repeat workmanship errors, especially someone they used to work beside.

CAUSES COMMON TO SAFETY AND QUALITY

1 **The playbook is too long to use during a shift** FROM THE CALL

At 200 pages, coaches can't find the right action when a problem happens.

2 **Coaches were promoted from technician roles**

They are skilled at the work but have had little practice leading people or holding them to a standard.

3 **Flow wins when goals conflict**

When safety or quality conflicts with keeping the cell moving, coaches choose output.